Michael Garcia

Contact Information

Institute for Research on Labor & Employment (IRLE)
Berkeley, CA

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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Economics of Crime and Corrections, Economics of Education, Racial Inequality, Determinants of Poverty

Education

University of California, Berkeley — 2021-2024
Bachelor of Arts in Economics

Howard University — Summer 2023
AEA Summer Training Program

Pasadena City College — 2017-2021
Associate in Science in Social and Behavior Sciences for Transfer

Research Experience

Research Associate, Institute for Research on Labor and Employment (UC Berkeley) — 2024-Present
Advisor: Steven Raphael

Pre-doctoral Research Fellow, Democracy Policy Lab (UC Berkeley) — 2024-Present
Advisor: Jacob Grumbach

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Marco Antonio Firebaugh Scholars Program (UC Berkeley) — 2023
Advisor: Steven Raphael

Fellowships and Awards

Latinx Research Center, Faculty-Mentored Undergraduate Research Fellowship (FMURF) — 2021-2024
Advisor: Steven Raphael

Senate Certificate of Recognition, from 9th district Senator Nancy Skinner — 2023

UC Berkeley, Chancellor's Public Service Award — 2023

Pasadena City College, Dean's Honors — 2018-2021

Senate Certificate of Recognition, from 25th district Senator Anthony J. Portantino — 2020

County of Los Angeles Certificate of Recognition, from 5th District Supervisor Kathryn Barger — 2020

Pasadena City College, Service to the Community Award — 2019

Pasadena City College, Leadership Scholarship — 2019

Pasadena City College, Composition Achievement Award — 2019

Work in Progress

"The Hungry Mind of United States Youth: How Universal Free Meals Narrow Student Achievement Gaps" (Working Paper – Presented at APPAM 2026)

"The Effects of Mandatory Reporters on Child Abuse"

"Church Sermons Influence on Undocumented Immigration"
(with Nela Mrchkovska and Ernesto Tiburcio)

"The Effects of Declining Incarceration Rates on the Socioeconomic Outcomes of High-Risk People" (with Steven Raphael)

Seminars and Conferences

	APPAM Fall Research Conference (Association for Policy Analysis and Management)	2026
	LRC Research Initiative Symposium (UC Berkeley)	2022-2024
	AEA Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (Howard University)	2023
	Marco Antonio Firebaugh Scholars Research Symposium (UC Berkeley)	2023

Affiliations

AEA Summer Program Alumni (Advanced Track)

Professional Development

The National Data Archive on Child Abuse and Neglect (NDACAN), Summer Research Institute, Cornell University	2026
Criminal Justice Administrative Records System (CJARS) Training Workshop, University of Michigan	2026
Getting into Graduate School, UC Berkeley	2023
Underground Scholars Policy Fellowship, UC Berkeley	2022
Social Sciences Research Pathway, UC Berkeley	2021

Service

Ambassador Coordinator, Berkeley Underground Scholars	2022-2023
Transfer Coordinator, Berkeley Underground Scholars	2023
Haas Public Service Leader Program, UC Berkeley	2022
Mathematics Tutor, Pasadena City College	2018-2021
Economics Tutor, Pasadena City College	2018-2021
Community Engagement Leader, Pasadena City College	2019-2021

Languages

English (fluent)

Skills

Programming: R, Python, Stata, LaTeX, Microsoft Suite (Excel, Word, PowerPoint)
Research: Data Analysis, Statistical Inference, Policy Analysis, CITI Program Certified

Last updated: November 13, 2026